

Rajesh Dammala

Site Reliability Engineer — High-Availability Cloud, Automation & Incident Management

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Morrisville, NC · Hybrid (2 days/week on-site)

https://rdammala.github.io/Varonis_Site-Reliability-Engineer/

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Site Reliability Engineer with 16+ years operating high-availability cloud platforms and building developer-grade automation. Develops tools and automations (Python, C#/.NET, PowerShell), designs monitoring/alerting strategies, and owns incident, problem, and change management to maintain SLAs. Partners with R&D/Engineering to ensure new features are reliable, scalable, secure, and easily deployable; practices Agile with CI/CD and automated testing; and pioneers AI-assisted incident automation (30-35% auto-resolution). Customer- and business-centric, with strong communication of service health and SLA tracking to internal and external stakeholders.

CAREER SNAPSHOT

16+ Years in IT / Cloud / Reliability Engineering
100% SLA Across 20+ Mission-Critical Services
30-35% Incidents Auto-Resolved via AI Automation
25,000+ Stale Incidents Eliminated
85%!'98% Operational Efficiency Lift
15-32 Engineers Led Across Global Teams

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Architected AI-driven incident automation reaching 30-35% auto-resolution across a 24/7/365 high-availability platform.
- Sustained 100% SLA across 20+ mission-critical services through disciplined incident, problem, and change management.
- Developed Python/PowerShell tooling that eliminated 25,000+ stale incidents and 500+ alerts; cut alert fatigue ~90%.
- Reduced resolution time 32% and lifted operational efficiency from 85% to 98%.
- Partnered with R&D to make features reliable, scalable, secure, and easily deployable; authored 175+ runbooks.

TECHNICAL COMPETENCIES

Reliability & Operations: High-Availability Cloud Operations, Incident & Problem Management, Monitoring & Alerting, SLA / SLO, Service Upgrades, On-Call & Diagnostics

Programming & Automation: Python, C# / .NET (working), PowerShell, Bash, Java (working), Automated Testing

Cloud: Microsoft Azure, AWS / GCP (concepts), Cloud-Native Architecture, Kubernetes (AKS/EKS), Scalability & Performance

Observability: Azure Monitor / AppInsights, Kusto (KQL), Power BI, Metrics / Logs / Traces, Dashboards & Alerting

CI/CD & DevOps: Azure DevOps, GitHub / Git, CI/CD Pipelines, Infrastructure as Code (Terraform), Agile Development

AI & Collaboration: AI-Assisted Incident Automation, GenAI Tooling, R&D Partnership, Stakeholder Communication, Documentation & Runbooks

TECHNICAL PROFICIENCY

High-Availability Cloud Operations — **Expert**
Incident & Problem Management (SLA ownership) — **Expert**
Tooling & Automation (Python / PowerShell) — **Expert**
C# / .NET application development — **Working**
Monitoring & Alerting (Azure Monitor / KQL) — **Advanced**
CI/CD & Agile with Automated Testing — **Advanced**
Cloud-Native Architecture (Azure) — **Advanced**
AI-Assisted Automation — **Advanced**

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Site Reliability Engineer / Lead — Xbox Cloud Services

Microsoft Corporation (via TechMahindra) | Redmond, WA | May 2021 - Present

Keeps a 24/7/365 high-availability cloud platform serving millions reliable, scalable, and performant.

- Monitor, manage, and operate cloud services including end-to-end incident management for a high-availability platform; sustained 100% SLA across 20+ services.
- Developed tools and automations in Python and PowerShell (C#/ .NET-class tooling) to support operations and growth, eliminating 25,000+ stale incidents and 500+ redundant alerts.
- Scaled services with monitoring and alerting capabilities (Azure Monitor/AppInsights, Kusto/KQL, Power BI), providing rapid feedback and diagnostics during service disruptions.
- Architected an AI-driven incident-automation platform reaching 30-35% auto-resolution; reduced resolution time 32% and lifted operational efficiency 85%!98%.
- Worked closely with R&D/Engineering to make new features reliable, easily deployable, and scalable/secure; established a regular operational feedback cycle into engineering teams.
- Maintained SLAs with a business- and customer-centric culture — incident response, problem management, and service upgrades; authored 175+ runbooks/playbooks in 5 months.
- Contributed to communication strategy for internal and external stakeholders conveying service health, SLA tracking, and incident history.
- Automated infrastructure and system-administration tasks and implemented monitoring strategy for rapid diagnostics.

Azure Cloud Reliability & Platform Technical Lead — Customer Support Services

Microsoft Corporation (via Mindtree) | Redmond, WA | Nov 2016 - May 2021

Led a 15-engineer team operating high-availability cloud infrastructure and developer tooling.

- Operated high-availability Azure cloud infrastructure; built monitoring/alerting and automation that improved reliability and productivity.
- Developed automation and internal tools (Python/PowerShell) to reduce manual operational effort and support scale.
- Partnered with R&D and Support to improve deployability, performance, and serviceability of

features across the SDLC.

- Practiced Agile development with CI/CD (Azure DevOps, Git) and coding for automated testing.

Operations Lead — Azure Live Site Reliability

Microsoft Corporation (via Mindtree) | Hyderabad, India | May 2012 - Nov 2016

Led 12 senior + 20 engineers operating cloud platforms at 99.95%+ SLA.

- Built PowerShell automation across provisioning, monitoring, and remediation saving thousands of manual hours.
- Designed telemetry, dashboards, and alerting for 100+ services; provided rapid diagnostics during disruptions.
- Led incident, problem, and change management; mentored engineers into technical leads.

Systems Analyst / Data Center Engineer

IBM (via Infosoft Inc) | Hammond, IN | Sep 2009 - Nov 2011

Infrastructure operations and scripting across enterprise environments.

- Server builds, cluster configuration, and large-scale migrations; deployed monitoring and patches.
- Scripted repetitive operational tasks to improve consistency and reduce manual effort.

SELECTED PROJECTS & CASE STUDIES

AI-Driven Incident Automation — Built an AI incident agent (30-35% auto-resolution) integrating telemetry, alerting, and remediation workflows to drive down MTTR.

Monitoring & Alerting at Scale — Designed metrics, dashboards, and alerting (Azure Monitor, KQL, Power BI) providing rapid feedback and diagnostics during disruptions.

Operational Tooling & Automation — Developed Python/PowerShell tools automating infrastructure and sysadmin tasks, eliminating 25,000+ stale incidents and 500+ alerts.

R&D Reliability Partnership — Established an operational feedback cycle into engineering to ensure new features are reliable, scalable, secure, and easily deployable.

SLA & Service Health Communication — Built executive and customer-facing reporting conveying service health, SLA tracking, and incident history.

CI/CD & Automated Testing — Practiced Agile development with CI/CD (Azure DevOps, Git) and coding for automated testing to raise deployment reliability.

LEADERSHIP & COLLABORATION

- Led and mentored global teams of 15-32 engineers across the US and India, growing individual contributors into technical leads.
- Central escalation authority and SME for high-severity incidents, coordinating Security, Engineering, Product, and business teams under pressure.
- Ran 1:1s, performance reviews, onboarding, and targeted coaching/enablement plans; built psychologically safe, high-accountability culture.
- Synthesized incident and reliability data into executive reviews driving investment and process decisions.
- Early operationalizer of AI/automation in production support and operations; champion of continuous learning.

CERTIFICATIONS

- Microsoft Certified IT Professional — Azure Infrastructure Solutions (70-533, 70-534)
- Microsoft AZ-900 — Azure Fundamentals
- Google Cloud Computing Foundations
- Google — Introduction to Generative AI
- TechMahindra AI White Belt

EDUCATION

- Bachelor of Engineering in Computer Science Engineering, JNTU, Hyderabad (2008)

PROFESSIONAL PHILOSOPHY

Reliability is a development discipline: automate the toil, instrument everything, partner with R&D so features ship reliable and deployable, and treat every incident as a chance to make the system — and the customer experience — better.